

RETAIL LAYOUT OPTIMIZATION: CATEGORY DRIVERS & TRIAL READOUT

Strategic Evaluation & Rollout Recommendation

Prepared for Quantum data analytics job simulation
by forage

The trial store layouts delivered positive, measurable uplift across all locations, led by a definitive +29.1% sales surge in Store 77.



Key Insights

Sales are disproportionately driven by Older Families (Budget segment).

The category is firmly anchored by Kettle brand and 175g pack sizes.



Trial Outcomes

All three trial stores outperformed their historical baselines.

Store 77 captured massive latent traffic; Store 88 improved basket intensity.



Final Recommendation

Proceed with a phased chainwide rollout, utilizing Store 77's execution as the primary spatial blueprint.

Does the new trial layout sustainably improve chip category sales, and does it warrant the capital investment of a chainwide rollout?

■ **The Complication**

Changing physical store layouts carries significant operational cost and risks alienating existing shopper habits.

■ **The Objective**

Isolate the true commercial impact of the new layout from normal seasonal variation and baseline store growth.

■ **The Deliverable**

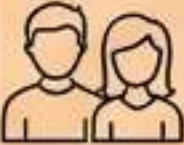
A definitive, data-backed recommendation on whether to scale the intervention.

Establishing a Rigorous Baseline



Commercial Meaning: By ensuring control stores perfectly mirrored trial stores before the test, any sales divergence during the trial window represents the true, **isolated impact** of the layout.

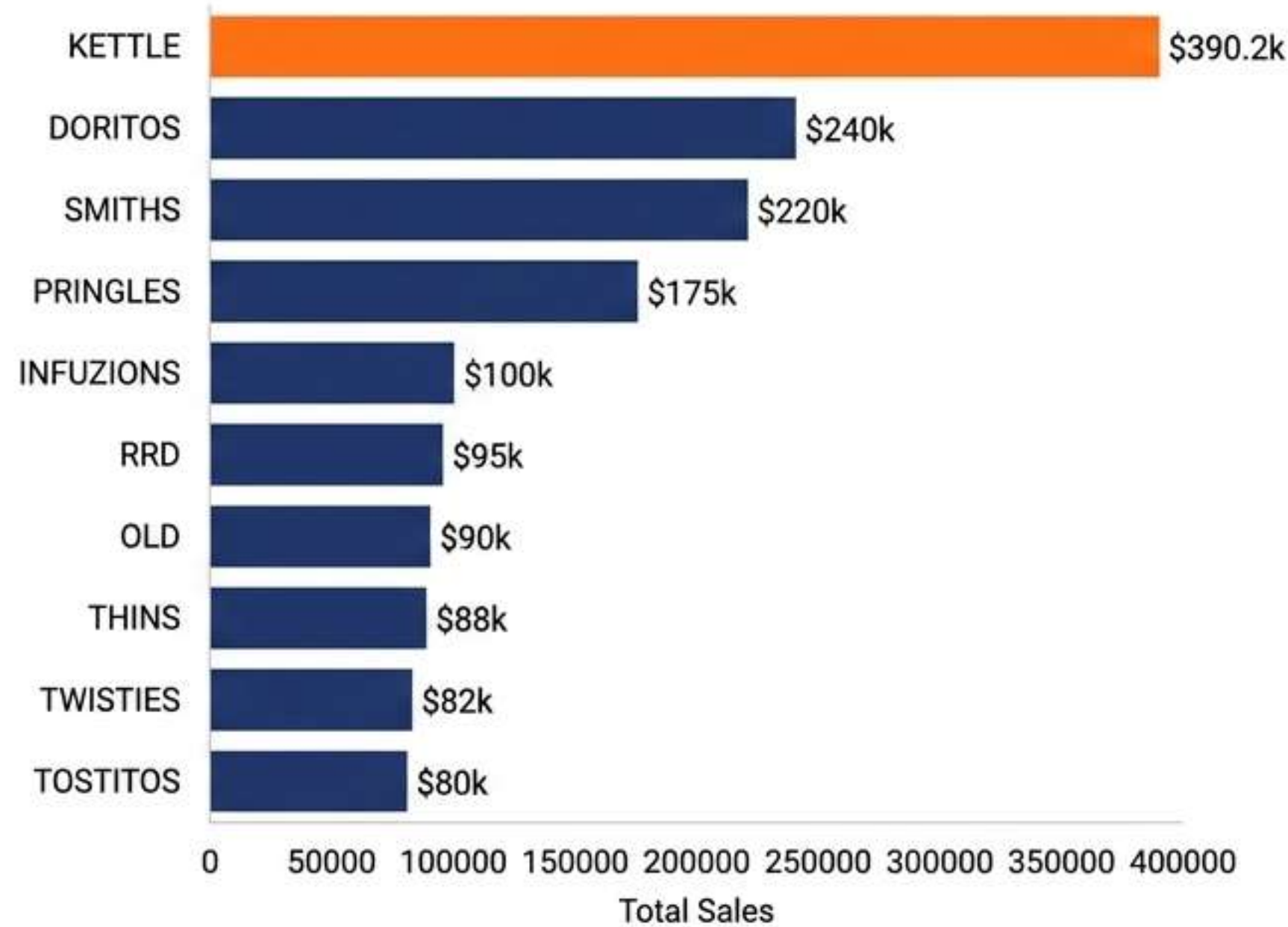
The Category is Anchored by Family Cohorts

Budget	Mainstream	Premium
Older Families (Budget) \$168.4k (Core Value) 47.8	Retirees (Mainstream) \$155.7k (Stable Spend) 42.5 Young Singles/Couples (Mainstream) \$157.6k (Volume Led) 60.5	
Midage Singles/Couples (11.8)		Midage Singles/Couples (36.6)
New Families (20.9)		New Families (20.8)
Older Singles/Couples (33.6)		Older Families (26.6)
Retirees (20.3)		Older Singles/Couples (21)
Young Families (25.3)		Retirees (23.7)
Young Singles/Couples (26.8)		Young Families (17.9)
	Midage Singles/Couples (36.8)	
	New Families (50.5)	
	Older Families (46.8)	
	Older Singles/Couples (42.4)	
	Young Families (38.8)	

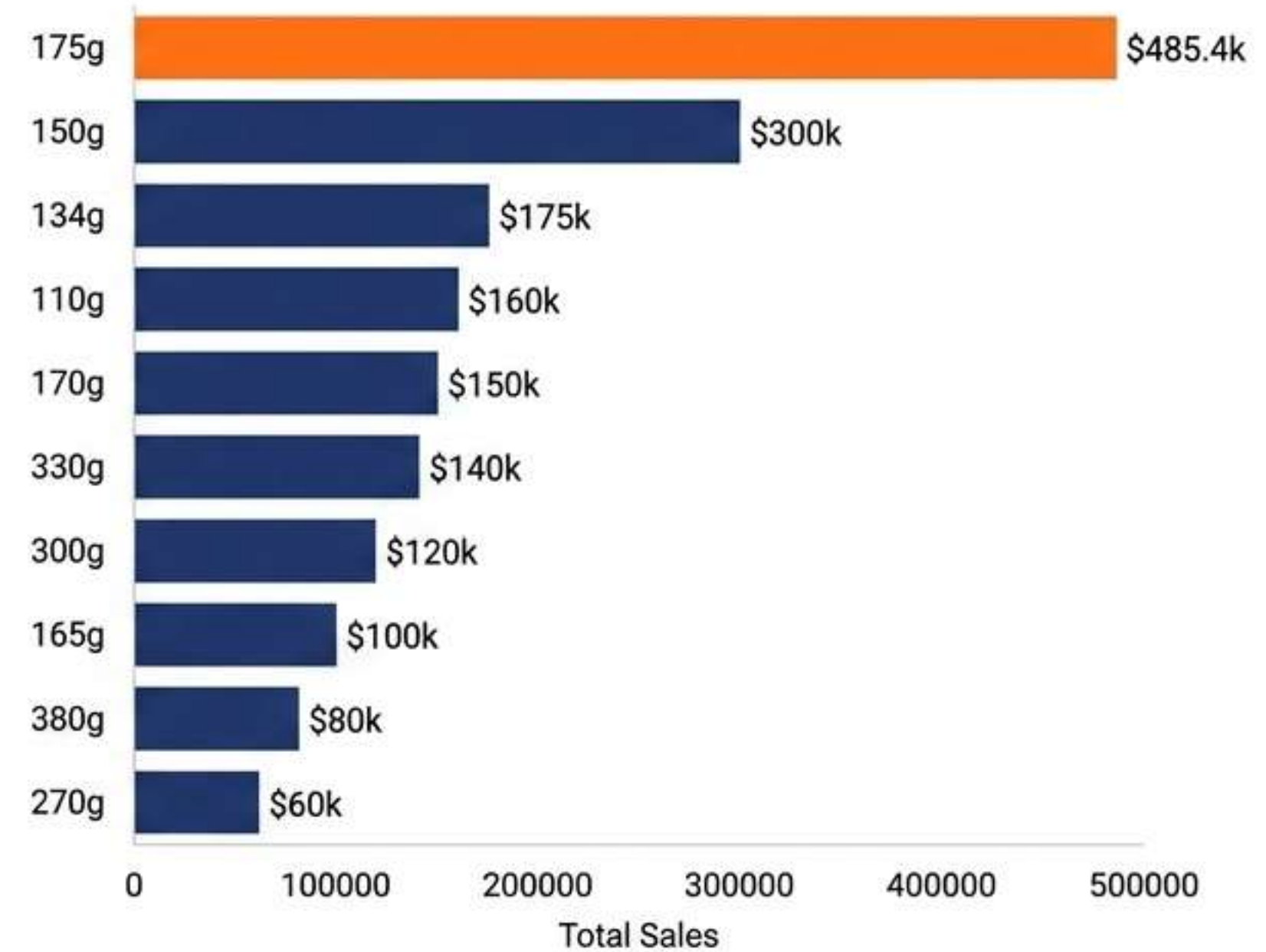
Commercial Meaning: The category is not monolithic. High-value households are family-oriented, requiring prominent family-value messaging to maintain baseline revenue.

Kettle and 175g Dominate the Portfolio

Top Brands

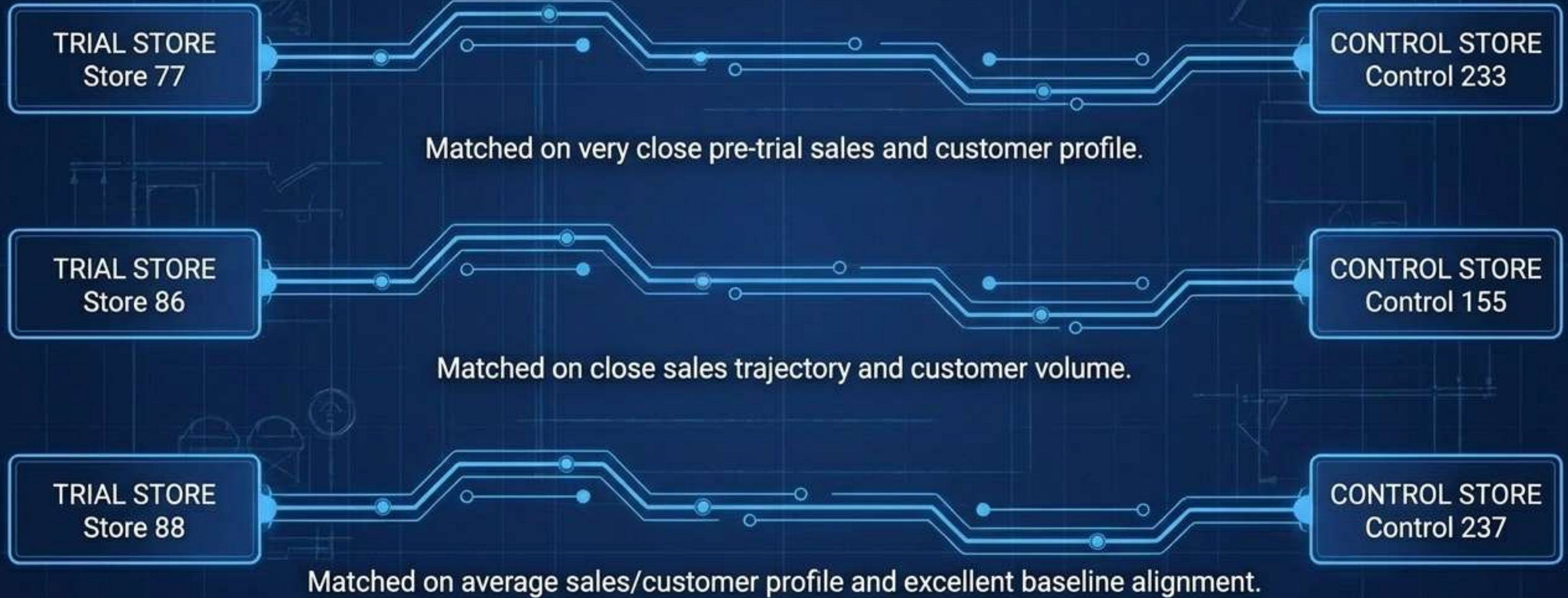


Top Pack Sizes



Commercial Meaning: Standard family-size packs carry the ultimate commercial weight. Regardless of layout changes, these anchor products must retain premium, unobstructed visibility.

Trial Methodology: Ensuring a Like-for-Like Test



Commercial Meaning: These pairings ensure we are measuring the layout's actual performance, not preexisting demographic or geographic advantages.

Store 77: The Undisputed Winner

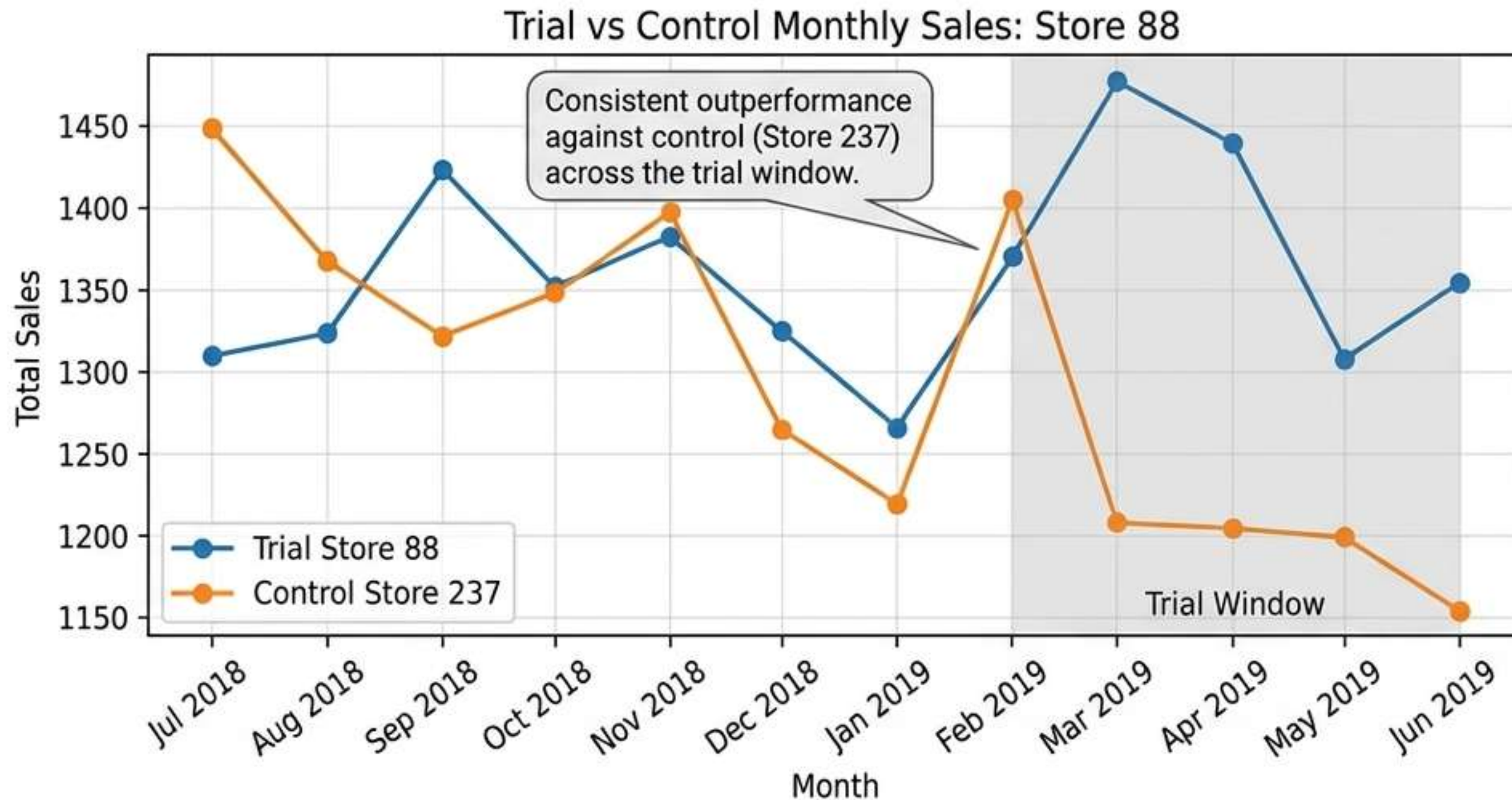


Sales Uplift
+29.1%

Customer Uplift
+23.5%

Commercial Meaning: Traffic increased massively without cannibalizing basket size. The layout successfully captured latent shopper demand, providing the strongest case for a rollout.

Store 88: The Balanced Improver



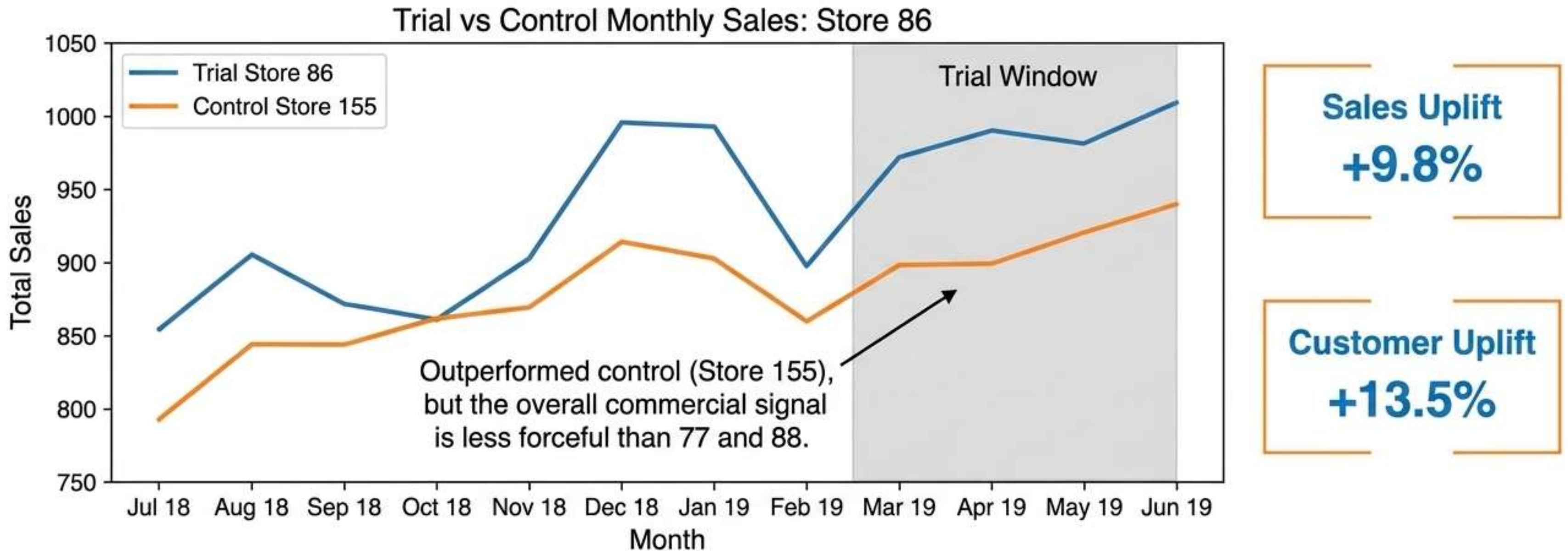
Sales Uplift
+12.3%

Customer Uplift
+5.8%

Transactions per Customer
+7.5%

Commercial Meaning: Store 88 offers the best balance. Even with modest traffic growth, the layout drove higher buying intensity per customer, maximizing the value of existing footfall.

Store 86: The Moderate Lift



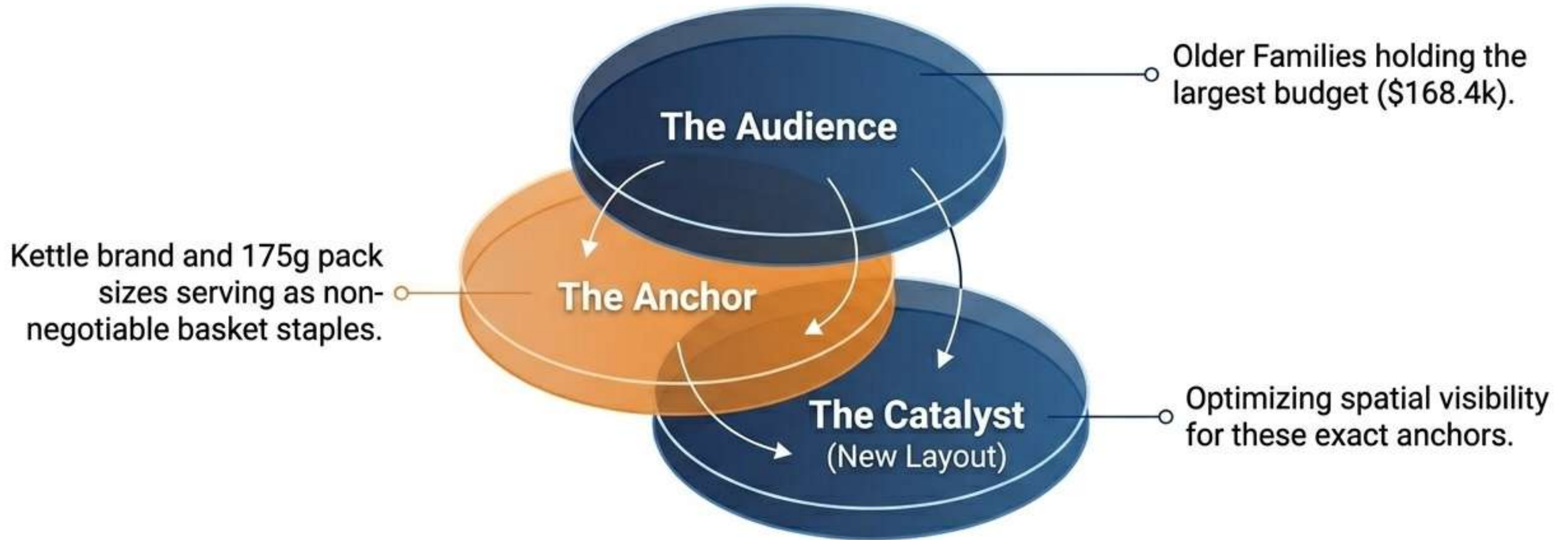
Commercial Meaning: The layout intervention is universally directionally positive, but varying magnitudes of success suggest specific execution details dictate the final ROI.

Trial Performance Scorecard

The trial was a universal success across three distinct environments.

Trial Store Diagnostic Matrix					
Store ID	Control Match Quality	Sales Uplift (%)	Customer Traffic Uplift (%)	Basket Intensity Uplift	Commercial Verdict
Store 77	Strong Match	+29.1%	+23.5%	Stable	Undisputed Winner
Store 88	Strong Match	+12.3%	+5.8%	+7.5%	Balanced Improver
Store 86	Good Match	+9.8%	+13.5%	Stable	Moderate Success

Strategic Synthesis: The Category Value Engine



The Insight

The trial layout succeeded because it reduced friction for the most valuable customer segment trying to find the highest-velocity products. The layout maximized existing behavioral gravity.

Final Commercial Recommendations



1. Phased Rollout

Scale the trial layout in phases, utilizing Store 77 as the primary architectural reference case due to its massive +29% yield.



2. Merchandising Strategy

Maintain unobstructed, premium planogram visibility for Kettle and 175g packs. They are the financial anchors of the category.



3. Segment Targeting

Protect family-focused value messaging for Older/Young Families, while utilizing mainstream-led brand visibility to convert Young Singles/Couples into repeat purchasers.



4. Risk Mitigation

Avoid a blind chainwide rollout. The moderate result in Store 86 proves that execution nuances matter.

Next Steps & Scaling Roadmap



Phase 1: Validation

(Next 30 Days)

Track the trial control logic for one additional reporting cycle to definitively confirm post-trial stability and baseline retention.

Phase 2: Standardization

(30-60 Days)

Audit the specific spatial and merchandising executions of Store 77 vs Store 86 to isolate the exact micro-factors that drove the 20% delta in performance.

Phase 3: Supply Chain Alignment (60+ Days)

Prepare supply chain forecasting to account for up to a 20%+ increase in Kettle/175g volume in Phase 1 rollout stores.